033. Al-Ahzaab ~ The Coalition

73 Ayaat (Madani)

FOCUS

COMMENTARY ON THE BATTLE OF AHZAAB
PURITY OF THE AHLULBAYT
THE PROPHETS' MARRIAGE TO ZAYNAB
DIRECTIVE TO SEND BLESSINGS ON THE PROPHET

DID YOU KNOW?

THE CHAPTER TAKES ITS NAME FROM THE ALLIANCE CONSISTING OF THE MAKKAN QURAYSH AND OTHER ARAB AND JEWISH TRIBES WHO FOUGHT THE MUSLIMS AT THE BATTLE OF THE TRENCH (KHANDAQUE) ALSO KNOWN AS THE BATTLE OF THE COALITION (AHZAAB)

SELECTED AYAAT

33:20	Ahzab
33:21	Rasulullah (pbuh) as role model
33:33	Ayatut Tatheer
33:35	Qualities of those rewarded
33:36	Freedom of no choice
33:41	Zhikr (remembrance)
33:56	Salawat
33:59	Hijab

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH THE NEGATION OF ZHIHAAR WHERE A MAN WOULD REJECT HIS WIFE BUT NOT FREE HER TO MARRY ANYONE ELSE, AND THE DIRECTIVE THAT ADOPTED CHILDREN WERE TO BE ATTRIBUTED TO THEIR BIOLOGICAL FATHERS.

IT THEN TRANSITIONS TO A DETAILED ACOUNT OF THE BATTLE OF AHZAAB (COALITION) OR KHANDAQUE (DITCH) WHERE THE TRIBE OF BANU NUDHAYR WHO WERE EXILED FROM MADINA FOR BREAKING A TREATY AND FORGED A COALITON WITH OTHERS INCLUDING THE QURAYSH TO ATTACK THE MUSLIMS. SALMAN AL FARSI RECCOMMENDED THE DIGGING OF A DITCH (KHANDAQUE) AROUND MADINA TO PROTECT IT. AFTER A LONG SEIGE OF OVER 3 WEEKS. DIVINITY SENDS A WINDSTORM, UPROOTING THE TENTS OF THE COALITION AND THE MAKKANS FLED.

THE CHAPTER CONTINUES TO HIGHLIGHT THE IMPORTANCE OF THE PROPHET AND THE STATUS OF HIS WIVES. THE BELEIVERS ARE COUNSELLED TO OBEY HIM WHEN HE HAS DECREED A MATTER.

THE PURITY OF THE FAMILY OF THE PROPHET IS HIGHLIGHTED IN VERSE 33 AS THE PEOPLE OF THE HOUSE (AHLULBAYT). LOVE FOR THE PROPHET AND HIS FAMILY IS REGARDED AS A FOUNDATIONAL COMPONENT OF FAITH.

THE INCIDENT OF THE PROPHET MARRYING ZAYNAB (EX WIFE OF HIS ADOPTED SON) IS MENTIONED AND A DIRECTIVE TO MOVE AWAY FROM GOSSIP AND OCCUPY ONESELF WITH THE REMEMBRANCE OF ALLAH.

IN ONE OF THE MOST CELEBRATED VERSES OF THE QUR'AN, THE CHAPTER DECLARES THAT ALLAH AND HIS ANGELS SEND BLESSINGS UPON THE PROPHET AND ENJOINS THE BELEIVERS TO DO THE SAME.